

MAXIMILIAN FONA

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SUMMARY

Third Year admitted Computer Science student at Michigan State University College of Engineering, concentrating in Cybersecurity accompanied with an accepted minor in Information Technology through the Broad College of Business. Hands-on experience in full-stack web development, microservices architecture, and system administration. Actively pursuing CompTIA Network+ and Security+ certifications and working on multiple security projects. Also pursuing future graduate courses in Computer Science.

EDUCATION

Michigan State University - East Lansing, MI *Expected May 2028*
B.S. Computer Science | Concentration: Cybersecurity | Minor: Information Technology | GPA: 3.5

Adlai E. Stevenson High School - Lincolnshire, IL *Graduated 2024*
Graduated with Highest Honors

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages	C, C++, Java, JavaScript (TypeScript, React), Python, Swift, HTML/CSS, SQL
Cybersecurity	CompTIA Network+ (in progress), Security+ (in progress), encryption fundamentals
Tools & Tech	Git, Docker, Flask, REST APIs, JWT authentication, microservices architecture
Productivity	Microsoft Excel (formulas, pivot tables, VLOOKUP, data analysis), Google Sheets, Word, PowerPoint
Databases	SQL (joins, indexing, execution order), ER diagram design, relational modeling
Soft Skills	Multilingual (English, Romanian), team collaboration, active listening, fast-paced adaptability,

EXPERIENCE

Technical Intern | Manoo Start Up - Remote *July 2026 - Oct 2026*

- Built a full-stack neighbor-to-neighbor rental marketplace app in React, collaborating with a team on features including item listings, in-app payments, and a hub-based pickup/dropoff system
- Implemented a gamification system (XP, levels, streaks, achievements, leaderboards) to drive user engagement and repeat usage
- Designed and iterated on the app's UI/UX, including a component-based design system, color/branding overhaul, and new interactive features, incorporating stakeholder feedback across design cycles
- Contributed to sustainability-focused product features, including a carbon-footprint tracking system that quantifies and visualizes each user's environmental impact

Website Developer Intern | Sekady Capital - Remote *May 2024 - Aug 2024*

- Developed and maintained website features using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript; collaborated with team members on requirements gathering and project planning.
- Participated in regular code reviews, delivering actionable feedback to improve code quality, maintainability, and adherence to best practices.
- Demonstrated strong problem-solving skills and a proactive approach to learning new technologies and development methodologies.

Waiter & Busboy | Chip's Café - Lincolnshire, IL

Sep 2021 - Aug 2026

- Managed high-volume service in a fast-paced environment, consistently prioritizing tasks to meet customer and kitchen demands.
- Operated POS systems, processed cash and card transactions accurately, and maintained food safety standards across all service areas.
- Communicated effectively across front-of-house and kitchen staff to streamline workflows and uphold a cohesive team environment.

PROJECTS

Dockerized Flask Microservices System - CSE 380, Michigan State University

- Architected a fully containerized web application using Docker, Flask, and REST APIs, integrating services for user management, document handling, full-text search, and request logging.
- Implemented JWT-based authentication with inter-service communication, applying secure system design principles aligned with the CIA Triad.

Founder and Manager of AI Media Instagram Account - Personal Project

- Founded and managed an Instagram account (40,000+ followers), independently overseeing content strategy, production, and growth
- Designed and executed an end-to-end AI content production pipeline (Leonardo AI, Hedra, Eleven Labs, Kling AI, Cap Cut) to produce a recurring short-form video series
- Developed a novel "AI news broadcast" content format, managing the full workflow from scripting to AI-generated visuals/voice to final video editing and publishing
- Managed content calendar and publishing cadence independently, applying a multi-tool AI stack to consistently ship short-form video content

Mock Venmo App - Personal Project

- Designed and developed a mock Venmo application in Swift, replicating core UI/UX flows including payment transfers, transaction history, and user profiles
- Built a functional front-end clone of a peer-to-peer payment app using Swift UI, focusing on intuitive navigation, responsive layouts, and clean visual hierarchy
- Practiced iOS design and front-end development by recreating a Venmo-style interface from scratch, including custom components, animations, and state management
- Independently designed and prototyped a mobile payment app UI in Swift, applying design principles like visual consistency, accessibility, and user flow optimization

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- CompTIA Network+ - In progress (target: August 2026)
- CompTIA Security+ - In progress (target: December 2026)

ACTIVITIES & HONORS

- Member, Delta Kappa Epsilon - Sigma Kappa Chapter, Michigan State University
- Member, Greeks in Engineering Club, Michigan State University